Hard Hat Inspection Checklist (OSHA 29 CFR 1926.100)

For site supervisors checking helmet use and helmet criteria in any area with head-injury hazards.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.100

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. For any Defect, record what you found and correct it before the employee works in the hazard area.
3. The helmet manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks, such as helmet condition; follow them as well.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.100: Head protection (Part 1926 Subpart E: Personal Protective and Life Saving Equipment) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-100-head-protection

SECTION A | Head-injury hazards and helmet use

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Impact hazards Ref. 1926.100(a)	Areas where a worker's head could be injured by impact are identified for the shift.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Falling objects Ref. 1926.100(a)	Areas where objects could fall onto workers' heads are identified.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Flying objects Ref. 1926.100(a)	Areas where objects could be propelled toward workers' heads are identified.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Electric shock or burns Ref. 1926.100(a)	Areas where employees face electric shock or burn hazards to the head are identified.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Helmets worn Ref. 1926.100(a)	Every employee in an identified area is wearing a protective helmet.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Helmet criteria

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
6	Helmet provided by employer Ref. 1926.100(b)(1)	Each employee has been provided with head protection by the employer.	☐	☐	☐	
7	ANSI Z89.1-2009 Ref. 1926.100(b)(1)(i)	Helmet label or documentation shows ANSI Z89.1-2009 (mark N/A if another listed edition applies).	☐	☐	☐	
8	ANSI Z89.1-2003 Ref. 1926.100(b)(1)(ii)	Marking or maker's data confirms ANSI Z89.1-2003 (mark N/A if another listed edition applies).	☐	☐	☐	
9	ANSI Z89.1-1997 Ref. 1926.100(b)(1)(iii)	Manufacturer's records confirm ANSI Z89.1-1997 (mark N/A if another listed edition applies).	☐	☐	☐	
10	Edition identified for every helmet Ref. 1926.100(b)(1)	Every helmet in use matches at least one of the three listed editions or has an equivalence record (section D).	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION C | High-voltage exposure

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Exposed employees identified Ref. 1926.100(b)(2)	Employees exposed to high-voltage shock and burn hazards are listed by name or task.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Electrical insulation Ref. 1926.100(b)(2)	Their helmets meet Section 9.7 (Electrical Insulation) of ANSI Z89.1-2009, -2003 or -1997, as shown on the label or maker's documentation.	☐	☐	☐	
13	No uninsulated helmets in use Ref. 1926.100(b)(2)	No employee exposed to high-voltage hazards wears a helmet lacking the Section 9.7 insulation specification.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Alternative helmets

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
14	Non-listed helmets identified Ref. 1926.100(b)(3)	Any helmet not built to a listed ANSI Z89.1 edition is identified by type and wearer.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Equivalence demonstrated Ref. 1926.100(b)(3)	The employer can demonstrate the helmet is equally or more effective than one built to a (b)(1) edition.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Evidence available Ref. 1926.100(b)(3)	The equivalence evidence can be produced on site or on request.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service

INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME